Ahmad Bishr Nasra



MD Candidate (Expected 2027) | Clinical Epidemiology & Quantitative Clinical Research

Faculty of Medicine, Damascus University

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Final-year MD candidate and medical researcher focused on Clinical Epidemiology and quantitative clinical research, with experience across the full research lifecycle, including study design, multicenter and multinational collaboration, data management, statistical analysis, interpretation, and scientific reporting. Has performed or contributed to statistical analyses for 50+ medical research projects and built an academic portfolio of 22 published peer-reviewed journal articles, 35+ original research manuscripts in active development or peer review, and 60+ completed peer reviews across 24 international medical journals. Research has been presented or accepted at major scientific meetings including ESMO Congress, MEACR, the ASCO Annual Meeting, SABCS, SAMS, MedGlobal, and AHR. Research interests center on epidemiologic and biostatistical methods, clinically meaningful evidence generation, and outcomes research, with principal clinical interests in oncology, particularly breast cancer, and gastroenterology.

EDUCATION

Doctor of Medicine (MD) — 2020 - Expected 2027

Faculty of Medicine, Damascus University

- Cumulative Average: **86.02%**
- Relevant coursework: Biostatistics (93/100); Epidemiology, Research Methodology and Medical Biostatistics (91/100); Evidence-Based Medicine (91/100).

High School Diploma - Scientific Stream

- Final Score: **98.1%**

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Clinical Elective in Emergency Medicine — Sep - Oct 2025

American University of Beirut Medical Center (AUBMC), Beirut, Lebanon

- Completed a four-week supervised elective at a tertiary academic medical center, with exposure to acute clinical assessment, patient management, and academic emergency medicine.

RESEARCH & ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP

Student Researcher — 2024 - Present

Faculty of Medicine, Damascus University

- Work across the **full research lifecycle**, including research-question development, study design, protocol and ethics preparation, data-collection planning, data management and quality control, statistical analysis, interpretation, manuscript development, submission, revision, and publication.
- Have performed or contributed to statistical analyses for **50+ medical research projects** across clinical, epidemiological, population-health, and health-services research.
- **Serve as a methodological and statistical collaborator** on investigator-led multicenter, multinational, clinical, laboratory-based, and population studies; responsibilities include data cleaning and restructuring, analytic-plan development, variable and outcome derivation, model selection, diagnostic and sensitivity analyses, interpretation, and publication-ready statistical outputs.
- Lead selected **large-scale and multicenter projects** across study development, team coordination, quantitative analysis, scientific writing, and dissemination; maintain **35+ original research manuscripts** at various stages of preparation, submission, and peer review.

Project Manager - Medical Research Empowerment (MRE) — 2025 - Present

International Research Initiative

- Coordinate collaborative research activities within an international initiative supporting medical students and early-career researchers across Arab countries.
- Mentor junior researchers in research-question development, study methodology, statistical reasoning, project planning, scientific writing, and progression from initial ideas toward active research projects.
- Support multicenter and collaborative research workflows by facilitating communication among junior researchers, project teams, and more experienced investigators.
- Help students identify suitable research opportunities, join active collaborative projects, and gain practical experience in research participation and scientific communication.

- Contribute to research-education activities designed to strengthen methodological understanding, research literacy, and independent participation in scientific research.

Co-Founder & Presenter - Damascus University Journal Club **2026 - Present**

Faculty of Medicine, Damascus University

- Co-founded the **first journal club at Damascus University**, establishing a student-led platform for critical appraisal, evidence-based medicine, research education, and structured discussion of scientific literature.
- Prepare and deliver sessions on study design, research methodology, statistical interpretation, bias, methodological limitations, and clinical relevance.
- Promote research awareness and advocate for greater student engagement in scientific research while mentoring students in critical appraisal, research-question development, study design, methodology, statistical analysis, scientific writing, and early project development through group sessions and individual consultations.
- Help students progress from learning research methodology to initiating their own projects, identifying research opportunities, and connecting with active research teams.

Co-Lead, General Surgery - SurgWeek-2 **2026 - Present**

National University Hospital, Damascus

- Selected as General Surgery Co-Lead for an international prospective multicenter surgical cohort; support site preparation, collaborator and mini-team coordination, protocol-standardized prospective data collection, and study implementation.

SELECTED QUANTITATIVE & METHODOLOGICAL EXPERIENCE

National Multicenter Prospective Surgical Outcomes Cohort, Syria **2025 - 2026**

- **First and corresponding author; study lead, central coordinator, statistical lead and sole analyst** of a prospective cohort across eight public hospitals in Damascus, Aleppo, and Lattakia; **405 patients** were enrolled, with **389 adults** included in the primary analysis and standardized follow-up at 1 week, 1 month, and 3 months.
- **Coordinated 24 hospital-based data collectors** and oversaw eligibility and data-quality queries, outcome derivation, and analytic development; conducted multivariable logistic and ordinal regression, longitudinal linear mixed models, GEE sensitivity analyses, estimated marginal means, model diagnostics, and extensive sensitivity analyses.

Skin Cancer Prevention and Early Detection Behaviors in Syria **2026**

- **First and corresponding author; statistical lead and sole analyst** of a study of **1,876 adults** examining skin-cancer prevention and early-detection behaviors; developed prespecified multivariable analyses with robust inference and sensitivity analyses. Preliminary findings were presented at ASCO 2026 and published as a Journal of Clinical Oncology meeting abstract.

Herbal-Remedy Use and Healthcare-Seeking for Gastrointestinal Symptoms **2026**

- **First and corresponding author; statistical lead and sole analyst** of a study of **819 adults** examining herbal-remedy use, misconceptions, healthcare-seeking, and responses to GI alarm symptoms; led psychometric assessment and four prespecified multivariable models, including modified Poisson regression with robust covariance, nonlinear modeling, and sensitivity analyses.

Career Regret, Academic-Related Factors, and Health-Related Quality of Life **2026**

- **Second author; statistical lead and sole analyst** of a multicenter study of **1,702 Syrian medical students**; led data management, psychometric assessment, multivariable linear regression with HC3 robust inference, model diagnostics, sensitivity analyses, and university-level random-intercept mixed-model analysis.

Dietary Patterns and Eating Behaviors Among Syrian Adults **2026**

- **Second author; statistical lead and sole analyst** of a study of **1,161 adults** using the TFEQ-R18; conducted three prespecified multivariable linear-regression models with reliability assessment, residual and influence diagnostics, heteroscedasticity assessment, and 1,000-resample bootstrap sensitivity analyses.

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES (22)

22 published

1. Nasra AB, Al-Dairy A, Almohamad A, Jabr A, Al-Dairy Y. Supravalvular aortic stenosis with aneurysmal dilation and infective vegetations of the aortic arch in a pediatric patient with Williams syndrome: a case report and review of the literature. *Journal of Medical Case Reports*. 2026. doi:10.1186/s13256-026-05868-5.

2. Nasra AB, Barghouth R, Al-Bitar A, Solaiman A. Incidental giant mesenteric lipoma: a case report. *Radiology Case Reports*. 2026. doi:10.1016/j.radcr.2025.10.022.

3. Abubakir M, **Nasra AB**, Sabbagh L, Barghouth R, Al Ali MM. Extensive cervico-vaginal ischemic injury reaching the bladder base following obstructed labor in a macrosomic pregnancy: a case report. *International Journal of Surgery Case Reports*. 2026. doi:10.1097/RC9.0000000000000062.

4. Al-Bitar A, **Nasra AB**, Alsaoub L, Aldakak MA, Saifo M. Synchronous bilateral breast cancer with heterogeneous histology: invasive ductal and lobular carcinoma: a case report. *Case Reports in Oncology*. 2025. doi:10.1159/000548545.

5. Nasra AB, Al-Bitar A. Complete resection of an incidentally discovered posterior mediastinal ganglioneuroma in an asymptomatic child: a case report. *Journal of Surgical Case Reports*. 2025. doi:10.1093/jscr/rjaf685.

6. Almawaz MY, Al-Assi F, Katbi E, et al. Quality of life and patient satisfaction among individuals with cutaneous leishmaniasis in Syria: a cross-sectional study. *Infectious Diseases of Poverty*. 2026. doi:10.1186/s40249-025-01409-2.

7. Al-Bitar A, Janoud O, Alyassin D, et al. Euthanasia in Syria: an examination of medical student attitudes and predictors in a conflict zone. *BMC Medical Ethics*. 2026. doi:10.1186/s12910-026-01402-w.

8. Al-Bitar A, **Nasra AB**, Alsaoub L, et al. Workplace violence in a conflict zone: a study from Syria's healthcare frontline. *BMC Public Health*. 2025. doi:10.1186/s12889-025-26102-9.

9. Nasra AB, Aldakak MA, Fallouh N, Alabdullah N, Darwish M, Alshurbaji MF, Alkhamis YA, Hammadieh A. Solid pseudopapillary neoplasm of the pancreatic head in an 18-year-old presenting with chronic intermittent abdominal pain: a case report. *Case Reports in Oncology*. 2026. doi:10.1159/000551633.

10. Aldakak MA, **Nasra AB**, Ahmad R, Abo Dakka Y, Ibrahim B, Souleiman Y. Recurrent hepatic hydatid disease presenting with biliptysis and suspected bronchobiliary fistula: successful management via thoracotomy, lung wedge resection, and diaphragmatic/subdiaphragmatic cyst evacuation. *Journal of Cardiothoracic Surgery*. 2026. doi:10.1186/s13019-026-04184-9.

11. Aldakak MA, **Nasra AB**, Abo Dakka Y, Ibrahim B, Chaban H. Late-presenting left Bochdalek hernia with intrathoracic transverse colon causing progressive exertional dyspnea: a case report. *Journal of Cardiothoracic Surgery*. 2026. doi:10.1186/s13019-026-04202-w.

12. Nasra AB, Tannous G, Aldakak MA, Ahmad R, Al Jabban Y, Sahloul W, Darwish B. Traumatic bilothorax following right thoracoabdominal gunshot injury: a case report of stepwise endoscopic and surgical management. *BMC Surgery*. 2026. doi:10.1186/s12893-026-03795-2.

13. Aldakak MA, **Nasra AB**, Ahmad R, Alhallaq H, Assoud K, Chaban H. Cytokeratin-positive pleomorphic chest wall sarcoma mimicking MPNST: a case report. *Cancer Management and Research*. 2026. doi:10.2147/CMAR.S606289.

14. Almansour S, Farhat R, Almansour M, Al-Deeb R, Daboul R, **Nasra AB**, Odeh ZA, Rajjoub N, Zeno M, Alshreibati F. Academic reading format preferences among Syrian medical students: a cross-institutional survey. *Advances in Medical Education and Practice*. 2026. doi:10.2147/AMEP.S604141.

15. Al Saleh M, **Nasra AB**, Hussein M, Fallouh N, Nassif E, Haj Kasem S, Al-Deeb R, Afeef M, Darwish T. Digital Eye Strain and Perceived Academic Burden Among Syrian Medical Students: A Multicenter Cross-Sectional Study of Symptom Burden and Associated Factors. *Advances in Medical Education and Practice*. 2026;17:630940. doi:10.2147/AMEP.S630940.

16. Al-Deeb R, **Nasra AB**, Aldakak MA, et al. Medication Access Barriers and Perceived Health Consequences in Post-War Syria: A Cross-Sectional Study in Homs. *Global Health Action*. 2026. doi:10.1080/16549716.2026.2726661.

17. Al-Deeb R, Aldakak MA, **Nasra AB**, Almansour S, et al. Emergency Care Competence and Resource Gaps Among Resident Physicians in Selected Syrian Governmental Hospitals: Implications for Health System Recovery. *Journal of Multidisciplinary Healthcare*. 2026. doi:10.2147/JMDH.S631468.

18. Gergeus R, **Nasra AB**, Barghouth R, Sheikh Ali D. Non-Radiographic Axial Spondyloarthritis Presenting with Anterior Chest Wall Pain without Inflammatory Back Pain in an HLA-B27-Negative Young Man: A Case Report Highlighting Diagnostic Challenges. *International Medical Case Reports Journal*. 2026. doi:10.2147/IMCRJ.S639166.

19. Al-Deeb R, Al Kheder T, **Nasra AB**, Kseibi H, et al. Patient Preferences Regarding Undergraduate Medical Student Participation in Clinical Care: A Multicenter Cross-Sectional Study in Syria. *Patient Preference and Adherence*. 2026. doi:10.2147/PPA.S644198.

20. Nasra AB, Shoari A, Abubakir M, Sabbagh L, et al. Preferences for physician sex among adults attending Syrian public teaching hospitals: A multicenter cross-sectional study. *PLOS ONE*. 2026. doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0359066.

21. Al Malla A, **Nasra AB**, Almansour S, Aldakak MA, Al Saleh M, Alkhateeb J, Salman LB, Latifeh Y. Knowledge gaps, primary care provider counselling, and barriers to diabetic retinopathy screening among adults with diabetes in Syria: a multicenter cross-sectional study. *Diabetes, Metabolic Syndrome and Obesity*. 2026;19:624626. doi:10.2147/DMSO.S624626.

22. Kheder M, **Nasra AB**, Alghoutani S, et al. Career regret, academic-related factors, and health-related quality of life among Syrian medical students: a multicentre cross-sectional study. *BMJ Open*. 2026;16(10):e118578.

SELECTED MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

1. Nasra AB, et al. Thyroid Cancer Knowledge and Self-Reported Neck-Checking Practices Among Adults in Syria: A Cross-Sectional Study. **Role:** *First author.*

2. Aldakak MA, **Nasra AB**, et al. Microbiological Spectrum and Antimicrobial Susceptibility of Digestive-System Isolates in Syria, 2022-2025: A Retrospective Laboratory Study. **Role:** *Corresponding author.*

3. Nasra AB, et al. Tuberculosis Care in a Conflict-Affected Setting: Knowledge, Stigma, and Traditional Healer Perspectives Among Syrian Medical Students. **Role:** *First author.*

4. Nasra AB, et al. Sex-Based Bias in Syrian Medical and Dental Education: Exposure, Institutional Climate, and Educational Consequences. **Role:** *First and corresponding author.*

5. Almansour S, Almansour S, **Nasra AB**, et al. Social Media Health Information, Verification, and Behavioral Responses Among Syrian University Students: A Cross-Sectional Study. **Role:** *Corresponding author.*

SELECTED CONFERENCE ABSTRACTS, PRESENTATIONS & AWARDS

European Society for Medical Oncology (ESMO) Congress

Madrid, Spain | 2026

- Accepted e-Poster: Missed prompt evaluation of gastrointestinal alarm symptoms: prevalence, recognition gaps, and barriers - Abstract #8540.
- Accepted e-Poster: Gaps in undergraduate oncology training and confidence among recent Syrian medical graduates - Abstract #4562.
- Accepted e-Poster: Family History of Cancer, Perceived Cancer Risk, and Readiness for Preventive Behavior Change Among Adults in Syria - Abstract #5376.
- Accepted e-Poster: Beyond Anticancer Treatment: Practical Unmet Needs, School Disruption, and Family Strain Among Syrian Children With Cancer - Abstract #8677.

Middle Eastern Association for Cancer Research (MEACR) 15th Annual Meeting

Aleppo, Syria | 2026

- Accepted Poster - First Author: Fatal Anaphylaxis Following Cyclophosphamide Re-exposure in a Young Adult With Thymoma Presenting as Superior Vena Cava Syndrome: A Case Report.
- Accepted Poster - Second Author: Anxiety, Distress, Coping, and Support Needs Among Patients Awaiting Oncology-Related Procedures: An Interim Cross-Sectional Study.
- Accepted Poster - Second Author: Persistent Vomiting Revealing Jejunal B-Cell Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma.

1st Atlantic Humanitarian Relief International Conference

Damascus, Syria | 2026

- Presenting Author: Beyond Discharge: Severity, Timing, and Predictors of Postoperative Adverse Events After Abdominal and Hernia Surgery in Syria.
- Contributed to **6 accepted posters**.

Syrian American Medical Society (SAMS) 24th International Conference

Aleppo, Syria | 2026

- Second Place Poster Award - Presenting Author: Unmet Needs in a Preventable Condition: Iron-Deficiency Symptoms, Knowledge, and Screening Gaps Among Syrian Adolescent Girls.
- Presenting Author: Multilevel Determinants of Surgical Outcomes in Syria: A National Multicenter Prospective Cohort Study.
- Co-author on 21 accepted posters.

MedGlobal - Best Scientific Research Competition at the New Syria Conference

Homs, Syria | 2026

- Presenting Author: Daily Commuting, Insomnia, Mindful Attention, and Academic Performance-Related Behaviors Among Students at Damascus University.
- First Place Poster Award - Co-author: Syrian Patients as Partners in Rebuilding Post-War Medical Education: Perspectives on Undergraduate Medical Student Participation in Clinical Care.
- First Place Poster Award - Co-author: Emergency Care Competence & Resource Gaps Among Syrian Physicians: Implications for Health System Recovery.
- Third Place Poster Award - Co-author: Landmine and Explosive Remnants of War Safety in Syria: A Cross-Sectional Survey of Civilian Knowledge, Attitudes, and Practices.
- Co-author on 7 accepted posters.

American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO) Annual Meeting

Chicago, Illinois, USA | 2026

- Determinants of skin cancer prevention and early detection behaviors in Syria: A cross-sectional survey. Journal of Clinical Oncology meeting abstract e22557.

San Antonio Breast Cancer Symposium (SABCS)

San Antonio, Texas, USA | 2025

- Fasting During Ramadan in Breast Cancer: Practices and Outcomes. Poster presentation, Abstract PS1-13-09.

30th Scientific Conference of the Syrian Association of Oncology

Damascus, Syria | 2025

- Synchronous Bilateral Breast Cancer with Heterogeneous Histology: Invasive Ductal and Lobular Carcinoma. Poster presentation.

PEER REVIEW SERVICE

Peer Reviewer **2025 - Present**

- Completed 60+ peer reviews across 24 international medical journals, evaluating study methodology, statistical reporting, interpretation, reporting quality, and clinical relevance.
- Reviewer for Advances in Medical Education and Practice; Annals of Medicine & Surgery; BMC Gastroenterology; BMC Surgery; Breast Cancer: Targets and Therapy; Cancer Management and Research; Clinical and Experimental Gastroenterology; ClinicoEconomics and Outcomes Research; Frontiers in Public Health; Global Health Action; International Journal of Emergency Medicine; International Journal of General Medicine; Journal of Cardiothoracic Surgery; Journal of Inflammation Research; Journal of Medical Case Reports; Journal of Pain Research; OncoTargets and Therapy; Primary Health Care Research & Development; Psychology Research and Behavior Management; Risk Management and Healthcare Policy; SAGE Open Medical Case Reports; The American Journal of Case Reports; The Application of Clinical Genetics; The Egyptian Journal of Bronchology.

RESEARCH METHODS & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Quantitative Analysis & Data Management: IBM SPSS Statistics, including GUI- and syntax-based workflows for data management, variable coding/derivation, model specification, diagnostics, sensitivity analyses, and reproducible analysis; descriptive and inferential statistics; parametric and non-parametric methods; categorical analysis; linear, binary/ordinal/multinomial logistic, modified Poisson, and Firth regression; GEE; longitudinal mixed models; reliability analysis; bootstrap and robustness analyses; statistical interpretation and visualization.

Study Design & Epidemiological Methods: research-question formulation; observational and cross-sectional design; prospective cohort workflows; retrospective and routinely collected data analysis; outcome definition; questionnaire development/adaptation; pilot testing; sampling and recruitment planning; longitudinal follow-up; multicenter coordination; protocol and ethics preparation.

Scientific Reporting & Publication: statistical-results reporting; manuscript and abstract development; scientific posters; publication-ready tables and figures; interpretation of findings; journal selection and submission preparation; reporting-guideline compliance; manuscript revision; response to peer review; resubmission workflows.

Research Leadership & Collaboration: end-to-end research project development; leadership of student research teams; coordination of large-scale, multicenter, and multinational projects; project tracking; delegation and team communication; collaboration with investigators and co-authors; junior-researcher mentorship; methodological and statistical consultation.

Research Tools & Platforms: IBM SPSS for statistical analysis and data management; KoboToolbox and Google Forms for electronic survey development and research data collection; Microsoft Word for scientific writing, manuscript preparation, and document formatting; basic proficiency in Microsoft Excel for data organization and routine spreadsheet tasks.

SCHOLARSHIPS

MASCC Membership Scholarship **2026**

Multinational Association of Supportive Care in Cancer

- Awarded a MASCC Membership Scholarship, supporting membership in the international supportive-care oncology community.

Syrian Youth Assembly (SYA) Coursera Scholarship

- Recipient of a scholarship through the Syrian Youth Assembly, providing access to Coursera educational opportunities.
- Completed 13+ certified courses from international universities and institutions through Coursera.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Undergraduate Student Member, European Society for Medical Oncology (ESMO), 2026 - Present.
- Member, American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO), 2026 - Present.
- Student Member, European Association for Cancer Research (EACR), 2026 - Present.
- Undergraduate Student Member, European Association for the Study of the Liver (EASL), 2026 - Present.
- Member, Multinational Association of Supportive Care in Cancer (MASCC), 2026 - Present.
- UEG Young Associate (Undergraduate Student), United European Gastroenterology (UEG), 2026.

LANGUAGES

Arabic: Native

English: CEFR C1 - IELTS Academic Overall Band 8.0

German: Currently learning

French: Basic